

Express Entry Document Checklist

A complete, phase-by-phase list of every document required for an Express Entry application - FSWP, CEC, and FSTP. Work through each phase in order and tick items off as they are confirmed ready.

The one rule that decides most files

Documents must be ready **before** the Invitation to Apply (ITA) arrives, not after. Once invited, you have **60 days** to submit a complete application - a hard deadline with no extensions. Police certificates, medical exams, and credential assessments can each take weeks to months to obtain.

Phase 1 - Before you create your profile

☐	Passport - valid, with the biographical data page scanned. Renew now if it expires within the next 12 months.
☐	Language test results - from an accepted test: CELPIP-General, IELTS General Training, or PTE Core for English; TEF Canada or TCF Canada for French. Results must be less than 2 years old when you apply. IELTS One Skill Retake is not accepted.
☐	Educational Credential Assessment (ECA) - required if your education is from outside Canada and you want education points. Use a designated organization: WES, ICAS, CES (University of Toronto), IQAS (Alberta), or ICES (BCIT). Architects, doctors, and pharmacists must use their profession's designated body instead. The ECA must be less than 5 years old both when you complete your profile and when you apply.
☐	NOC 2021 code confirmed - matched to your actual job duties, not your job title. Your reference letters must describe duties that correspond to this code.
☐	Provincial nomination certificate - if you hold one (adds 600 CRS points).

Phase 2 - While you are in the pool

☐	Keep the profile accurate - update language results, work history, and family status the moment they change.
☐	Proof of funds kept current - IRCC updates the required amounts every year (based on 50% of the low-income cut-off). Check the current table at canada.ca and update your profile when it changes. Required for FSWP and FSTP; not required for CEC, or if you are authorized to work in Canada and hold a valid job offer.
☐	Order police certificates early - you will need one for yourself and every family member 18 or older, from every country stayed in for 6 consecutive months or longer during the last 10 years (time before age 18 and time in Canada excluded).
☐	Locate your nearest IRCC panel physician - only a panel physician can do the immigration medical exam. Know where yours is before the ITA arrives.
☐	Employment reference letters drafted - see the standard on the next page. Getting a compliant letter from a past employer is often the slowest single document.

Phase 3 - After the ITA: your e-APR upload set (60 days)

The online system generates a personalized checklist from your profile. Expect it to ask for the items below.

☐	Police certificates - per the rule in Phase 2. If one cannot arrive in time, upload proof that you requested it plus an explanation.
☐	Proof of funds - official letter on bank letterhead: account holder name, account numbers, opening dates, current balance, 6-month average balance, and outstanding debts. CEC applicants and valid job-offer holders upload a letter explaining the exemption instead.

	Immigration medical exam - done by a panel physician after your ITA, as close as possible to your application date. Upload the information printout sheet or IMM 1017B Upfront Medical Report. Family members need exams even if they are not coming with you.
	Employment reference letters - for every position claimed for points (see standard below).
	Birth certificate(s) - if declaring dependent children.
	Marriage certificate - if married; IMM 5409 statutory declaration if common-law; divorce certificate and separation agreement if divorced; death certificate if widowed; adoption certificate for adopted dependants.
	IMM 5476 Use of Representative - only if you hired a representative.
	Digital photos - to confirm identity, if requested in your personalized checklist.
	Certified translations - any document not in English or French needs a stamped certified translation (or a translator's affidavit) plus a scan of the original or certified photocopy. Stamps and seals must be translated too.

The employment reference letter standard

The single most common documentation failure in Express Entry files. Every letter must contain all of the following:

	Printed on official company letterhead with full company address, phone number, and email
	Recent issue date, and the signatory's name, job title, and direct company contact details
	Your full legal name exactly as in your passport
	All job titles held, with exact start and end dates for each
	Minimum 5 specific duties per role - matching the NOC description you claimed
	Hours per week stated explicitly (full-time = 30+ hours/week)
	Annual salary or hourly rate, with the currency stated
	Company stamp or seal (expected practice for Indian employers)

Consistency check before you upload

Dates must match across every document: reference letters, payslips, appointment letters, relieving letters, and tax records. A mismatch an officer cannot reconcile is treated as a credibility problem, and at worst as misrepresentation - which carries a 5-year ban.

Sources

Every rule and figure in this document was verified against the following official pages on 19 July 2026:

- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/documents.html
- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/apply-permanent-residence.html
- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/documents/language-test.html
- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/documents/education-assessment.html
- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/documents/police-certificates.html
- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/documents/proof-funds.html

Important - please read

The information provided is for informational and guidance purposes only, based on publicly available Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship Canada (IRCC) regulations and policies. This does not constitute legal advice, and no solicitor-client or consultant-client relationship is created by accessing this content. Immigration regulations, program requirements, processing times, and CRS cutoff scores are subject to frequent change without notice. You are responsible for verifying all information with official IRCC sources (www.canada.ca/immigration) and confirming current eligibility requirements before taking any action.